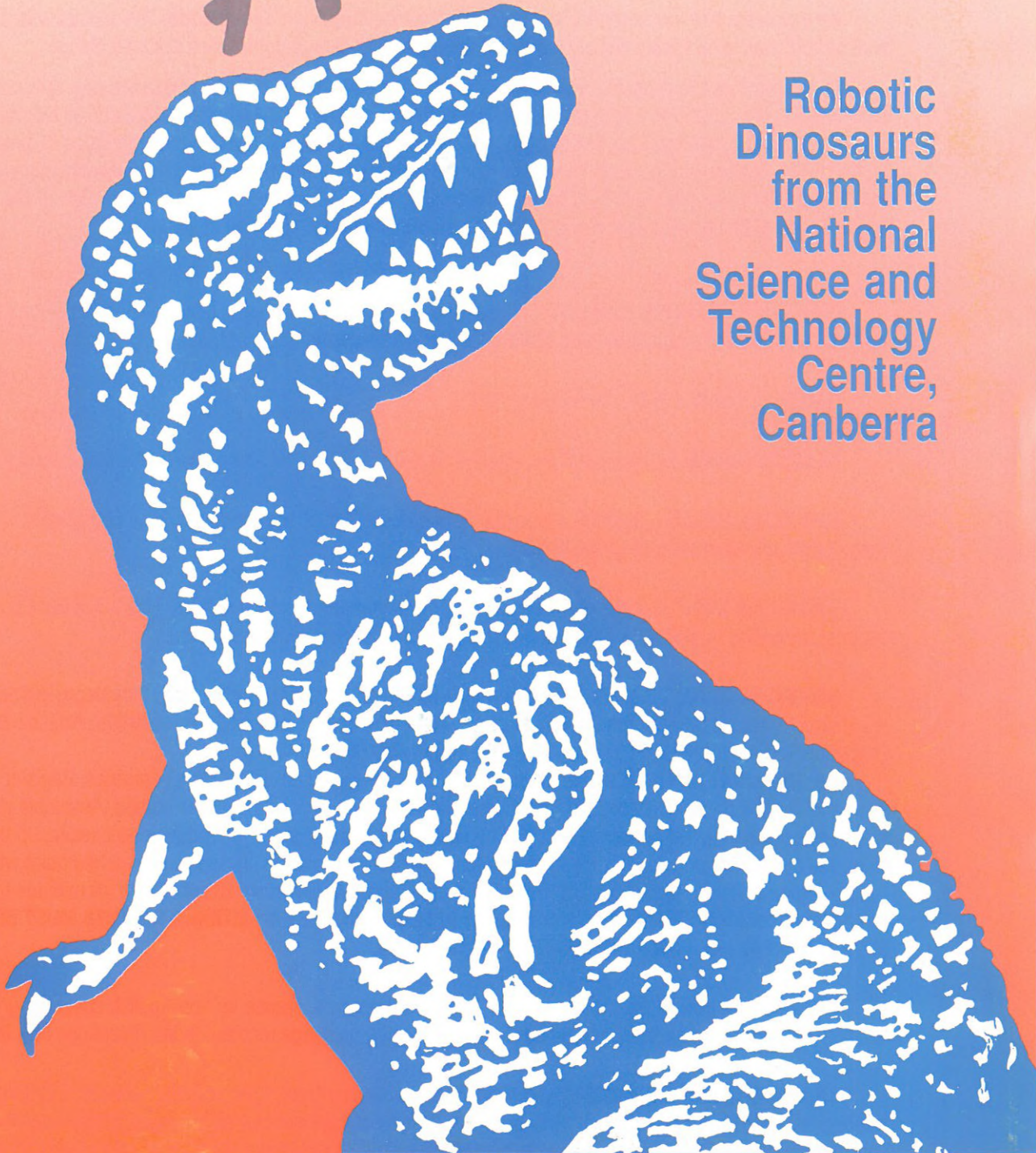


DINOSAURS

Alive!

Robotic
Dinosaurs
from the
National
Science and
Technology
Centre,
Canberra



MUSEUM OF VICTORIA

328 SWANSTON STREET, MELBOURNE, VICTORIA 3000

22 OCTOBER 1989 - 4 FEBRUARY 1990



The Museum of Victoria is about to be invaded by dinosaurs. Seven life-like mechanical reconstructions of dinosaurs will be on display for three months commencing Sunday, 22 October, 1989.

These specimens, powered by an elaborate arrangement of air-driven machinery, make life-like movements and sounds.

They are a mixture of quite familiar dinosaurs and ones less well known. **Tyrannosaurus**, **Stegosaurus** and **Brontosaurus** (now known as *Apatosaurus*) are names familiar to many who are not dinosaur enthusiasts. The others are the duck-billed **Parasaurolophus**, the horned meat-eater **Ceratosaurus** and **Styracosaurus**.

The most complete Australian dinosaur discovered to date, **Muttaburrasaurus**, is represented by both a life-like mechanical model and a cast of the skeleton on which the model was based.

An eighth life-like model rounds out the exhibition, the sailbacked **Dimetrodon**. This animal was not a dinosaur but was in fact more closely related to the mammals, the group to which humans belong.

Supplementing the exhibition will be skeletal dinosaur specimens from the museum's own collections. **Mamenchisaurus**, a 22 metre long relative of **Brontosaurus**, will be exhibited reared up on its hind limbs as though browsing in the top branches of a tree. Although artists previously have depicted groups of dinosaurs feeding in this manner, no museum has ever mounted a skeleton in this pose. Whether these dinosaurs could and did actually browse on their hind legs remains a disputed topic among palaeontologists. One of the purposes of exhibiting this specimen is to test the plausibility of such a mode of behaviour.

ADMISSION CHARGES: Adults \$5, Concessions \$2 (Children 4-15 years, pensioners, unemployed, full-time students and student group bookings). **Children under 4 years free.**

DATES: 22 October, 1989 - 4 February, 1990.

MUSEUM HOURS: Daily 10 am-5 pm. (Closed Christmas Day). Last admission to *Dinosaurs Alive!* 4.30 pm.

ENQUIRIES: General 669 9888; Education Service 669 9866; Community Services 669 9997.
Enter Exhibition from Russell Street door.

EXHIBITION SHOP: A range of special dinosaur merchandise will be available. This will include printed materials including books and posters and a selection of dinosaur models and kits.

SCHOOL BOOKINGS: As this exhibition will be extremely popular it is important that all groups book in advance. The cost is \$2 per student, one teacher will be admitted free for each ten students. Please call the Education Service Booking Officer on (03) 669 9866 or (03) 669 9864.

INFORMATION FOR TEACHERS: Enter the Museum through the Russell Street entrance. Register at the desk and deposit bags. As storage is limited large school bags will not be accommodated. Assemble students at the area designated for schools. Enter McCoy Hall at the schools' entry point before proceeding up the stairs along the mezzanine and downstairs to the exhibition entrance. Hold the students at a marked point whilst paying admission fees. Payments to be made by cheque to the Museum of Victoria. Allow 40 minutes to view the exhibition. **NO PAPERS OR PENCILS WILL BE ALLOWED IN THE EXHIBITION. STUDENTS MUST BE UNDER SUPERVISION AT ALL TIMES DURING THE MUSEUM VISIT.**

COMMUNITY SERVICES: Conducted tours and interpreter assistance for non-English speaking groups are available. Additional programmes to be advertised. Advance bookings recommended. Telephone (03) 669 9997.

TRANSPORT AND PARKING: The Museum is accessible by tram, train and bus services. Limited metered parking is available in the vicinity of the institution. Wheelchair access can be arranged at the Russell Street entrance. Further enquiries for people with disabilities should be directed to Community Services (03) 669 9997.

National tour sponsored by T.S.G., The Commonwealth Transport & Storage Group.